

Red Team Transparency Report for AbsurdSenapiii Labs and Founder Joel A. N. Crisostomo

Introduction

This report provides an adversarial **red team analysis** of AbsurdSenapiii Labs and its founder, **Joel Angelo Nodado Crisostomo**. AbsurdSenapiii Labs is a self-described “*independent AI alignment lab*” with an unconventional blend of activities spanning AI research, blockchain, and even collectibles ¹. In a public transparency effort, we scrutinize the company’s public persona, operations, and potential risk areas from an outsider’s critical perspective. The goal is to surface **observable risks** and weaknesses that a determined adversary or skeptic might exploit or highlight. All information is drawn from public sources provided, ensuring that our analysis remains factual and evidence-based.

Company Overview

AbsurdSenapiii Labs presents itself as an **AI alignment research lab** focused on public-good projects, but with a notable twist – it operates at the intersection of AI and crypto. According to its public profile, the lab is “building public-good AI alignment research nodes” and engaging in “*on-chain research*” as well as “*secondary markets*” ¹. The lab claims to have **scaled to 2 million impressions organically** on social media, hinting at a growing online reach ².

- **Mission and Activities:** On the surface, AbsurdSenapiii Labs’ mission aligns with AI safety/alignment, aiming to produce research that benefits the public. It showcases “live projects” involving AI media pipelines and research frameworks ³. Uniquely, the lab also references an “*emotional TAM (Total Addressable Market) portfolio*,” which appears connected to the founder’s ventures into collectibles and culture ³. This unconventional scope – bridging **AI research, crypto markets, and even anime trading cards** – is a distinguishing trait. It suggests a broad interpretation of “alignment” that extends beyond AI algorithms into aligning market incentives and cultural assets.
- **Public Presence:** The company maintains an active online presence for thought leadership and community engagement. Its X (Twitter) account emphasizes “*building... in the open*” and highlights the “*Execution ≠ narratives*” mantra ², implying a focus on tangible results over hype. AbsurdSenapiii Labs also uses its LinkedIn account to post insightful commentary on diverse topics (from startup investing to education), thereby cultivating an image of broad expertise. For example, on an Antler VC post the lab commented that the most durable startup ideas come from “*lived friction*” in real problems ⁴, and on an NUS post it discussed adapting pedagogy in an AI-driven world ⁵. This savvy online engagement has helped the lab punch above its weight in visibility. However, it also raises questions about whether this is **genuine thought leadership or strategic narrative-building** (more on this risk later).

- **Organization and Structure:** Little is publicly known about the internal structure or funding of AbsurdSenapiii Labs. There is no clear indication of a team beyond the founder, suggesting it may be essentially a **one-person lab** or a very small team. The company's name itself – “AbsurdSenapiii” – is informal and meme-like, blending the word “absurd” with a play on “*senpai*” (a Japanese term) or the founder's handle. This non-traditional branding is eye-catching in crypto circles, but could be perceived as unprofessional or perplexing in academic or enterprise contexts. An adversary might question if the lab's **branding and scope are too eccentric** for serious endeavors, potentially undermining its credibility with certain audiences.

Founder Profile

Joel Angelo Nodado Crisostomo is the founder and apparent driving force behind AbsurdSenapiii Labs. His public footprint portrays a *multifaceted innovator* straddling AI research and crypto investment. Key aspects of his profile and background include:

- **Experience and Expertise:** Joel's personal LinkedIn commentary suggests firsthand experience in both startup operations and crypto markets. He writes from the perspective of someone who has “*experienced how incentives fail under stress, how liquidity disappears when you actually need it*” in crypto, and the hard lessons of startup life (like “*hiring before product-market fit*” and managing “*reputation risk*”) ⁴. These remarks imply he has been in the trenches – possibly having worked at or founded a crypto startup or managed investments during volatile market conditions. However, beyond these anecdotes, **concrete details of his career history or credentials are not publicly obvious**. An ORCID iD was provided, hinting at an academic orientation, but we found no listed publications or university affiliations via that ID. This lack of clear credentials could be a point of attack for skeptics: **Is Joel a proven expert in AI alignment or just self-taught?** An adversary might highlight the absence of peer-reviewed research or traditional AI lab experience, raising doubts about the depth of his expertise.
- **Publications and Research Output:** The lab's GitHub repository and writings are central to Joel's work. Feedback from a Web3 research community (Ethos) indicates that AbsurdSenapiii Labs produced an “*alignment writeup*” that was notably hands-on and experimental, rather than “*just repeating the same RLHF patterns*.” One commentator remarked it's “*one of the few... that feels like it came from people who actually tested things*” rather than copying standard Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback approaches ⁶. This suggests Joel's work might indeed be original and technically robust. On the other hand, **operating outside of established research institutions means less external validation**. The same Ethos thread praises the lab's novel “comparison operating system” framework for evaluating projects, but those are community comments rather than formal peer review ⁷ ⁸. A critic might concede Joel's ingenuity yet question if the work has undergone rigorous scrutiny for biases or errors. The **risk is that without independent validation, novel methods could have hidden flaws** that undermine conclusions, which an adversary could exploit to dismiss the lab's findings.
- **Reputation and Communication Style:** Joel comes across as articulate and knowledgeable in public forums. He often adopts a poised, analytical tone whether on Twitter/X or LinkedIn. For instance, he tweeted about “*building public-good AI alignment research, on-chain, in the open*” and proudly noted that after “*2M impressions... [they are] still shipping*”, underscoring a commitment to execution over talk ². On LinkedIn, his AbsurdSenapiii Labs persona delivers concise insights (e.g., “*The most*

interesting ideas often look wrong under old assumptions... identify the inflection before consensus does.” ⁹). While these lend him credibility as a thoughtful participant in discussions, an adversary might interpret this as **carefully crafted personal marketing**. The polished nature of his commentary could be seen as *calculated narrative framing*, aimed at boosting his and the company's profile. This exposes him to **claims of “all talk, no proof”** if tangible outputs don't match the thought leadership. It's a delicate balance – the *Execution ≠ Narratives* slogan sets a standard that critics will certainly hold him to.

Key Projects and Unconventional Initiatives

AbsurdSenapiii Labs has embarked on some non-traditional projects that blend technology, finance, and culture. These initiatives demonstrate creativity but also carry unique risks when viewed adversarially:

- **AI Alignment Research Framework:** The flagship output from the lab appears to be a framework for comparative analysis of complex systems (nicknamed an “OS” for evaluations). In a case study, the lab compared two protocols (“Lighter” vs “Pacifica”), using a mirrored, systematic approach: shared evidence logs, identical evaluation templates, etc. ¹⁰ ¹¹ . Community feedback praised this consistency for removing narrative bias and potentially setting a new benchmark for analysis ¹⁰ . However, from a red-team lens, this very methodology could be **attacked on complexity and transparency grounds**. An opponent might say: *“The framework is a black box – how do we know it's unbiased? If only the lab's team understands this ‘evaluation OS’, they could tweak it to favor their opinions.”* The detailed process (with custom scoring pillars, unknown weighting logic, etc.) ¹² , while innovative, might be hard for outsiders to trust without open, reproducible documentation. Until the lab clearly publishes how scores are derived (as even community members urged them to do ¹¹), there's a **reproducibility and trust gap** that skeptics could seize upon.
- **“Emotional TAM” Collectibles Experiment:** One of the most striking AbsurdSenapiii Labs undertakings is what the founder calls an *“emotional TAM research”* project – essentially, **cornering the market on anime trading cards as a cultural experiment**. The lab's Carousell listing for a *“Weiss Schwarz Vault”* (a vault of graded anime TCG cards) reveals they acquired *“one of the largest high grade anime TCG collections in Singapore”* in a **two-week “speedrun”** ¹³ . The listing explicitly frames this as part of research, stating: *“All acquired within a two week speedrun as part of our emotional TAM research at AbsurdSenapiii Labs... This is cultural infrastructure.”* ¹³ . The price was set at the meme-worthy **\$S\$69,420** (not for actual sale, just to show off), and it even quips: *“If you truly want to own something like this... ape our company stock instead.”* ¹⁴ . From a risk perspective, this initiative is **highly unorthodox**:
- **Credibility Risk:** An AI lab spending resources on anime collectibles could be easy fodder for detractors. It may appear frivolous or tangential to the core mission of AI alignment. Critics could spin this as the founder indulging a personal hobby under the guise of research. The **“ape our company stock” joke** also walks a fine line – to outsiders, it might imply the lab has a stock or is seeking investors, which could be seen as **unprofessional if not clarified as humor**.
- **Financial Risk:** Rapidly buying out a market segment (even “for research”) has financial implications. If company funds were used, an adversary would question the **fiduciary judgment** here. Is this a prudent allocation of resources, or reckless speculation? The lab calls it *“not a liquidation lot”*, meaning they don't intend to sell quickly ¹³ , but that ties up capital in illiquid assets. From an

adversarial viewpoint: **What if the lab faces a cash crunch?** This collection could become a problematic asset – hard to liquidate without a loss, undermining financial stability.

- *Reputation and Focus:* On the flip side, the vault was presented as “*cultural infrastructure*” and a demonstration of “*full supply absorption*” in a niche market ¹⁵. It signals that the lab is experimenting with how narrative value can be created in markets (perhaps analogous to how meme stocks or NFT markets work). While intellectually interesting, this broadens the lab's scope to the point of appearing **scattershot**. An observer could doubt whether the lab is truly focused on AI alignment or just “doing a bit of everything” in tech and crypto culture. Such perception could erode trust among serious stakeholders (e.g., an AI safety grant committee might look askance at anime card antics).
- **On-Chain and Open Research:** AbsurdSenapiii Labs emphasizes that its research is conducted “*on-chain*” and “*in the open*”. This likely means they use blockchain transactions or decentralized platforms (like the Ethos.app) to record research output and perhaps to **reward community feedback** (some Ethos posts were bounties with payments). The *public-good node* phrasing suggests an ethos of transparency and decentralization. The adversarial consideration here is **data integrity and IP security**. By putting work out openly and perhaps immutably on-chain, the lab could face issues if sensitive insights or code are exposed too early:
- Others might **appropriate the research** or front-run the lab's ideas. An established AI lab or crypto firm could lift concepts from AbsurdSenapiii's public work without credit, beating them to publication or productization.
- There's also **no undo button on-chain**. If a flawed analysis or errant data is committed, it's permanently visible. A malicious actor could seize on a mistake etched in the blockchain to discredit the lab (“See, even their *smart contract* says their result was X, which was wrong.”).
- The commitment to open-source is admirable, but it invites **constant scrutiny**. AbsurdSenapiii Labs will need very rigorous standards to withstand that scrutiny; any oversight could be amplified by skeptics who have full access to the evidence.

Observable Risks and Vulnerabilities

Taking an adversarial perspective, several key risk areas emerge for AbsurdSenapiii Labs and its founder:

1. Credibility and Legitimacy Risks

Questionable Domain Expertise: Without a clear academic or industry pedigree in AI, Joel Crisostomo's authority in the complex domain of AI alignment can be challenged. Detractors could point out that **no peer-reviewed publications or known collaborations** back up the lab's alignment research. The innovative methods (e.g., new RLHF-alternative techniques) need external validation. Until then, it's easy for a skeptic to dismiss the lab as “*reinventing the wheel in a silo*.” Moreover, the lab's very name and branding, while distinctive, might not be taken seriously in formal circles. *AbsurdSenapiii Labs* doesn't sound like MIT or DeepMind – an unfair but real bias that could be held against it.

Broad Focus – “Jack of All Trades” Perception: The lab's remit spans **AI safety, crypto markets, and even cultural assets**. While this interdisciplinary approach is part of its identity, an adversary will frame it as lack of focus. They might say AbsurdSenapiii Labs is “*neither a pure AI lab nor a pure crypto fund – they dabble in*”

everything from DeFi to Pokémon cards (anime TCG), so how can they be truly expert at any of it?" This argument could resonate with potential partners or investors who prefer specialists. The risk is that being too novel and broad makes it hard to establish a *solid reputation in any one domain*.

Reliance on Founder's Persona: The company and founder's identities are tightly coupled. Joel's personal brand (tweets, comments, reputation in communities) is the bedrock of the lab's credibility. This creates a **single point of failure**: if an adversary manages to tarnish Joel's reputation, the lab's standing would likely collapse. For instance, any exposure of personal misconduct, or even a public mistake in analysis, could be disproportionately damaging. With no visible broader team or independent board, there's no mitigation or second layer of credibility. **Key-person risk** is high – something even Joel himself implicitly acknowledges by emphasizing lived experience and personal vision in his posts ⁴. An attack on his persona (even unfair or unrelated) could thus severely impact the lab.

2. Conflict of Interest and Objectivity

Investor vs. Researcher Role: AbsurdSenapiii Labs uniquely combines *research with investing activities*. The founder openly identifies as a *"secondary market crypto investor"* in addition to running the lab ¹. This dual role presents a classic **conflict of interest** risk. Can the lab's research conclusions be trusted if the founder holds financial stakes in the subjects of study? An adversary would be quick to claim bias: e.g., *"Of course their report favored Protocol X over Y – they're likely bagholders of X!"* Even the community has raised this concern in a constructive way. One of the lab's own public thought exercises was to *"stress test whether adding AI-infra public equities (stocks) strengthens or weakens the research identity"* ¹⁶ – essentially questioning if expanding into different investments would dilute trust. This shows the issue is on the founder's mind, but it's also an admission that the **perception of bias is a real threat**. Without clear disclosures and perhaps independent review of research, this conflict angle remains a viable attack vector on the lab's integrity.

Narrative vs. Execution (Potential Hypocrisy): The lab's motto *"Execution ≠ Narratives"* implies a stance against empty hype. Yet Joel/AbsurdSenapiii Labs engages heavily in **public narrative crafting** – polished LinkedIn essays, Twitter threads, meme-infused experiments. A cynical observer could accuse the founder of **falling into the very narrative trap he warns of**: spending effort to shape a story of being cutting-edge and effective, without publicly visible *"execution"* beyond prototypes and writings. For example, the lab's comparative reports and frameworks are described online, but has the lab *executed* any real-world alignment solution or shipped a product? The deliverables seem to be reports and community engagement rather than deployable tech (as far as public info shows). This leaves the lab open to the charge of *"all narrative, little execution,"* undermining its slogan. Such a criticism could stick if the lab doesn't demonstrate real-world impact soon, given the boldness of its messaging.

3. Operational and Strategic Risks

Lack of Institutional Support: As an independent outfit, AbsurdSenapiii Labs doesn't enjoy the backing of a larger institution. That means no built-in compliance department, PR team, or legal counsel – the usual support structure to handle crises or attacks. If, say, a controversy arose (imagine a misguided tweet or a misinterpreted analysis causing public outcry), the lab might struggle to respond in a polished, damage-controlled way. An adversary could exploit this by **mounting coordinated PR attacks** or even frivolous legal challenges, betting that an indie lab won't have the resources to fight on multiple fronts.

Financial Sustainability: The lab's funding sources are not public, but hints suggest it might be **self-funded via crypto gains or personal funds** (the founder's investor activities, etc.). Crypto-based funding is notoriously volatile – a market downturn could imperil the lab's budget. Also, the extravagant “emotional TAM” experiment of buying out collectibles ¹³, if done with company money, shows an appetite for aggressive bets. An adversary (or even just market forces) could turn this into a liability: e.g., if the anime card market crashes or if liquidity is needed, the lab could be forced to sell at a loss, becoming a cautionary tale. Also, inviting people to “*ape our company stock*” in jest ¹⁴ might age poorly if the lab ever seeks real investment – that joke could be recast as “*they were soliciting uninformed investors with memes.*” **Inconsistent financing or misinterpreted signals to investors can derail the lab's long-term plans.**

Scalability and Continuity: Right now, the lab's output seems driven by a very personal vision. There is scant evidence of a broader team of researchers or developers contributing. This raises questions of scalability: can AbsurdSenapiii Labs tackle multiple projects or a large-scale alignment challenge, or is it limited by the founder's bandwidth? An adversary might highlight that *one individual (no matter how talented) has limits*, and thus the lab's grand vision might be infeasible to realize alone. Moreover, continuity is a concern – if Joel were to step away (for health, personal reasons, etc.), would the lab even continue? The lack of visible succession planning or shared leadership is a risk savvy critics would note, especially for any stakeholders considering collaboration.

4. Community and Perception Risks

Edgy Branding Backfiring: The lab's integration of internet culture (memes, crypto slang, anime references) helps it connect with a Web3-native and young audience. However, this branding can alienate or alarm more traditional audiences. For instance, a government agency or conservative academic might question the seriousness of an “AbsurdSenapiii Labs” that posts meme numbers (69,420) in listings ¹⁴. An adversary could play on this divide, positioning the lab as “*just a crypto bro science project*” when talking to serious AI governance forums, or as “*out-of-touch intellectualism*” when talking to crypto anarchists – essentially using the lab's mixed identity to undermine it with whichever audience is least receptive to one side of it. This chameleon branding is risky: it's clever in context, but **in a different light it may undermine trust** and make the lab an easy target for ridicule.

Overexposure on Social Media: Joel and his lab are highly active on public platforms, which is double-edged. The benefit is community building; the risk is that every statement is a possible ammo clip for critics. Already, every detailed comment (LinkedIn or Twitter) is on record. An adversary could comb through these for inconsistencies or statements that can be taken out of context. For example, the lab's comments celebrating **decentralized, open systems and criticism of “old assumptions”** ⁹ might be twisted to claim the lab is dismissive of proven practices or unwilling to collaborate with mainstream experts (painting them as overly idealistic or arrogant). In short, the more you say, the more can be used against you. The lab's transparent philosophy means it must be extremely careful – any frustration vented online or a half-baked idea could be seized upon. **The openness that is AbsurdSenapiii's strength could also be its Achilles' heel** in the public arena.

Community Reliance: AbsurdSenapiii Labs has engaged communities like Ethos (for feedback and bounties) and leverages networks on Twitter and LinkedIn for mindshare. This is generally positive, but an adversary could attempt to **sour the lab's community relationships**. For instance, orchestrating brigading or negative feedback in those channels could shake confidence. If a few influential voices on Ethos or Twitter started questioning the lab's findings or integrity, it might cascade (given the herd dynamics in

online communities). The lab does not yet have a huge follower count (circa 800+ on X) ¹⁷, so it is relatively vulnerable to losing control of the narrative if faced with a concerted push of skepticism. In a sense, the community's perception is a **battleground** that the lab must continuously win – a savvy adversary knows this and could fight a war of public opinion to isolate AbsurdSenapiii Labs from its supporter base.

Conclusion and Mitigations

In summary, AbsurdSenapiii Labs is an innovative but **highly unconventional venture**, and that unconventionality is the source of both its strengths and its risks. From a red team standpoint, the lab's **multi-domain approach and public openness** present ample attack surface for critics:

- Its credibility can be undermined by highlighting the lack of traditional credentials and the presence of seemingly offbeat endeavors (like anime card vaults).
- Its objectivity can be questioned due to the blending of research with investment and self-promotion.
- Its operations can be portrayed as fragile – essentially a one-man show financed by volatile assets and guided by internet ethos.
- Its public image, while modern and engaging, can be reframed negatively to sow doubt among different audience segments.

Mitigations: To pre-empt or counter these adversarial angles, AbsurdSenapiii Labs may consider several steps: - **Increase Transparency & Validation:** Continue open-sourcing methods, but also invite third-party audits or collaborations to validate its research. External endorsements or co-authored work with established researchers could greatly reduce credibility risk. - **Clarify Financial/Conflict Policies:** Publicly state any holdings or investment positions related to its research and perhaps institute a policy (e.g., not investing in projects under active evaluation, or creating Chinese walls between research and investing arms). This would blunt accusations of hidden bias. - **Demonstrate Execution Tangibly:** To silence the “all talk” critique, the lab could highlight any concrete outcomes (software, benchmarks, tools) resulting from its work. Even if intermediate, showing prototypes or use cases where their alignment research made a difference would shift perception toward actual impact. - **Broaden the Team or Advisors:** Expanding the visible team or forming an advisory board of respected figures could alleviate key-person risk and signal that the lab isn't an island. Diverse voices would also help ensure the quirky culture doesn't become an echo chamber. - **Cultural Code-Switching:** The lab might adopt a more formal tone in certain channels (e.g., a whitepaper or the main website) while reserving the memes and slang for community forums. This way it can be taken seriously by traditional entities when needed, without losing its authentic voice among enthusiasts. Essentially, **context-aware branding** to avoid misinterpretation.

Ultimately, AbsurdSenapiii Labs and Joel Crisostomo appear to be pushing boundaries in how an independent lab can operate at the crossroads of emerging tech and culture. This very boundary-pushing invites skepticism, but with careful navigation it can also be the source of the lab's edge. By understanding the adversarial perspective – as outlined in this report – the lab can strengthen its **public transparency and resiliency**. Embracing a mindset of “nothing to hide, but plenty to prove,” will be crucial. In the spirit of alignment: aligning its bold narratives with undeniable execution will be the best defense against any red team attack.

Sources: Public information from AbsurdSenapiii Labs' online profiles and community interactions was analyzed to compile this report. Key references include the lab's social media bios and posts ¹ ⁴,

community feedback on its research ⁶, and the founder's own published content and experiments ¹³, among others, as cited throughout. All data is drawn from the provided links to ensure accuracy and transparency in this assessment.

¹ ² **Cookie.fun 1.0 (Alpha)**

<https://www.cookie.fun/accounts/691d815e3ae01fbd0d592854>

³ **Alignment Lab**

<https://alignmentlab.com/>

⁴ **The best ideas founders have come from their own experiences | Antler**

https://www.linkedin.com/posts/antlerglobal_the-best-ideas-founders-have-come-from-their-activity-7410250708874149888-oqkc

⁵ **#nusresearch #nusimpact | National University of Singapore**

https://www.linkedin.com/posts/national-university-of-singapore_nusresearch-nusimpact-activity-7410220822835130368-wvsA

⁶ ⁷ ⁸ ¹⁰ ¹¹ ¹² **Ethos | Web3 Credibility**

<https://ethos-base.deno.dev/broker/770>

⁹ **Pitching unconventional startups with 'bad ideas' that could be good | Adam French posted on the topic | LinkedIn**

https://www.linkedin.com/posts/adam-french-2192034a_venturecapital-advertising-startups-activity-7408793929845882880-TMtD

¹³ ¹⁴ ¹⁵ **AbsurdSenapiii Labs Weiss Schwarz Vault (Not for Sale), Hobbies & Toys, Toys & Games on Carousell**

<https://www.carousell.sg/p/absurdsenapiii-labs-weiss-schwarz-vault-not-for-sale-1408873621/>

¹⁶ **ALL PAID) Does expanding into AI-infra public equities strengthen ...**

<https://app.ethos.network/broker/post/763/does-expanding-into-ai-infra-public-equities-strengthen-my-research-identity-5~>

¹⁷ **Realiz @NotRealiz - Twitter Profile | TwStalker**

<https://www.twstalker.com/NotRealiz>